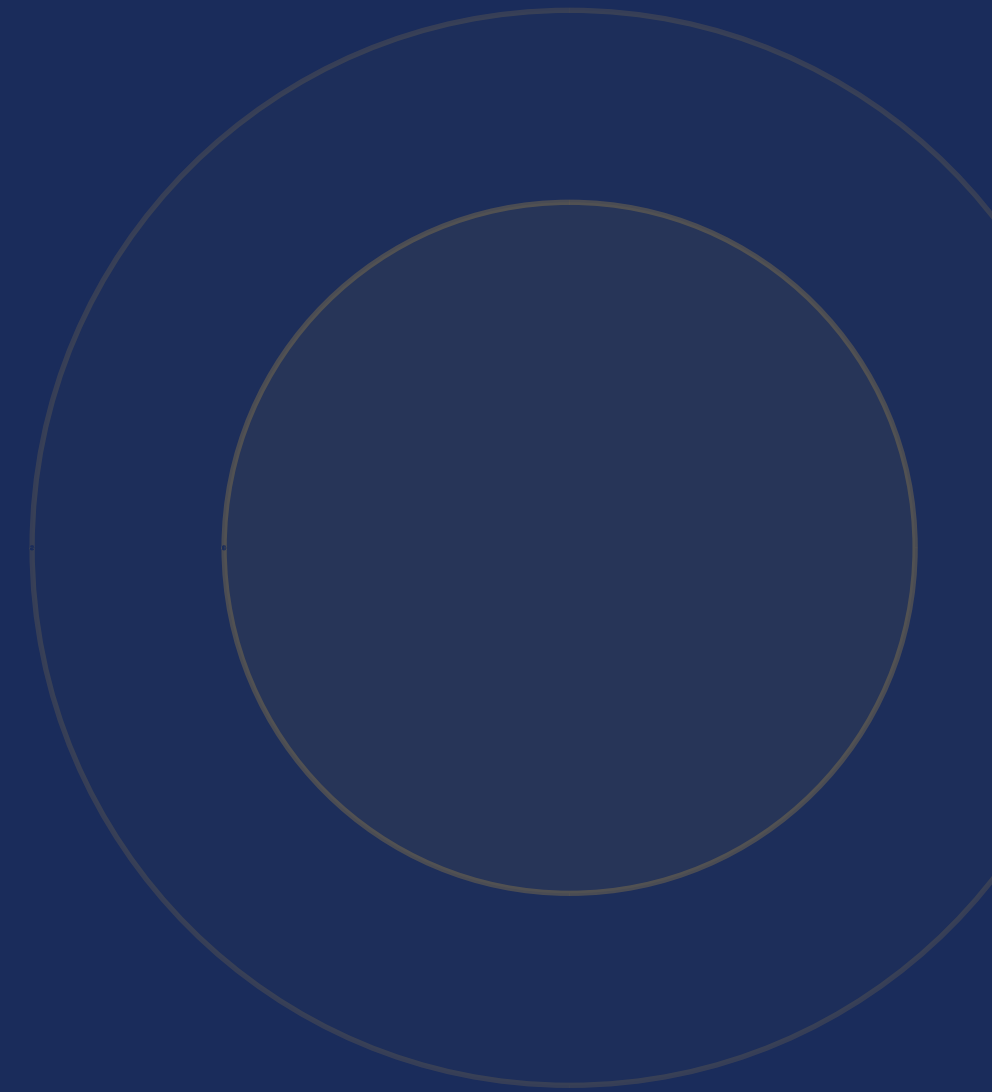


Contemporary Global Governance

Understanding the idea of Global Governance

The Contemporary World



What is Global Governance?

- System of rules, norms, and policies
- Guides interactions between countries
- Maintains global order

Different Global Actors

- Countries (states)
- International organizations (UN, ASEAN)
- NGOs, companies, citizens

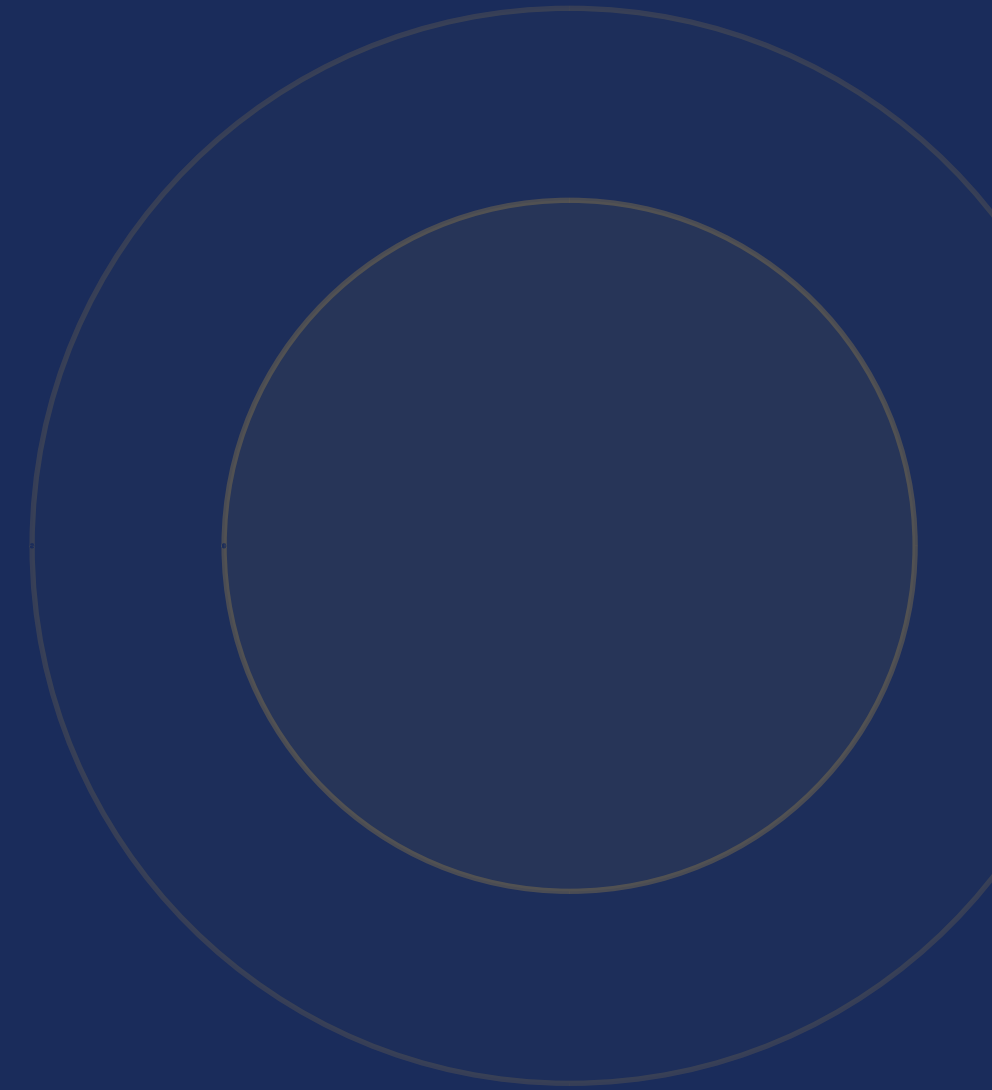
Global Governance Importance

- Solves global problems
- Climate change, pandemics, terrorism
- No single country can solve alone

The Rise of International

Organizations in Global Politics

The Contemporary World



What is Globalization?

- Global politics is shaped by a wide range of organizations that influence international relations, policy-making, and cooperation among states. These organizations can be broadly categorized into intergovernmental organizations (IGOs), non-governmental organizations (NGOs), and multinational corporations (MNCs). Each plays a distinct role in addressing global challenges such as security, economic development, human rights, and environmental sustainability
- Intergovernmental organizations are formed by sovereign states to promote cooperation and manage shared issues. One of the most prominent examples is the United Nations (UN), which was established in 1945 to maintain international peace and security. The UN facilitates diplomacy, peacekeeping missions, and humanitarian efforts. Similarly, the World Trade Organization (WTO) regulates global trade, ensuring that trade flows as smoothly and predictably as possible. These organizations provide a platform for negotiation and conflict resolution, reducing the likelihood of international disputes escalating into war.
- Non-governmental organizations operate independently from governments and often focus on advocacy, humanitarian aid, and social development. Organizations such as Amnesty International and the Red Cross play crucial roles in promoting human rights and providing disaster relief. NGOs often act as watchdogs, holding governments and corporations accountable for their actions. They also raise awareness about global issues and mobilize public opinion, which can influence policy decisions at both national and international levels.

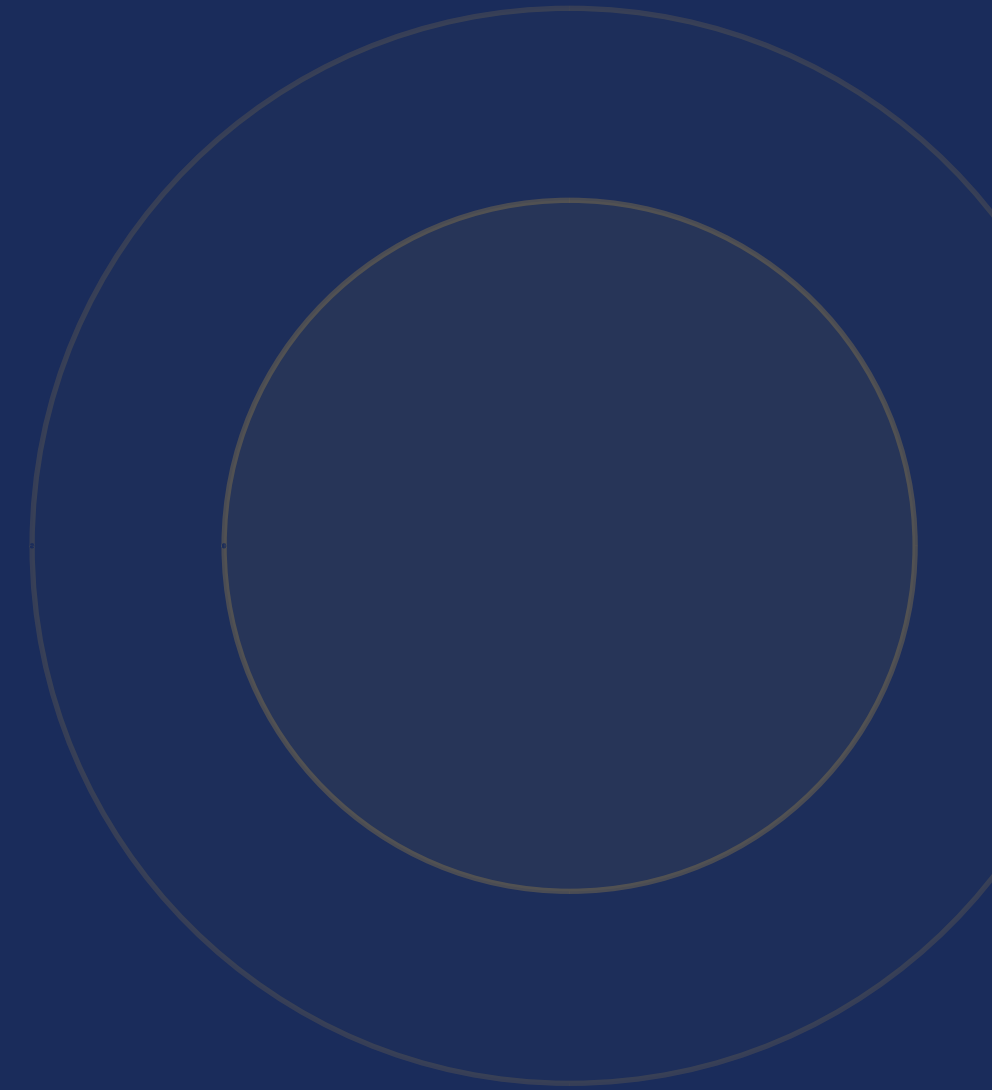
What is Globalization?

- Multinational corporations are another powerful force in global politics. Companies like Apple, Google, and Shell operate across multiple countries and have significant economic influence. Their investments can shape national economies, labor markets, and even political decisions. While MNCs contribute to economic growth and innovation, they are also criticized for prioritizing profit over social and environmental responsibility. This has led to increased calls for regulation and corporate accountability in global governance.
- In addition to these categories, regional organizations such as the European Union (EU) and the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN) play important roles in fostering cooperation among neighboring countries. These organizations focus on economic integration, political stability, and regional security. They demonstrate how countries can work together to achieve common goals while maintaining their sovereignty.
- Overall, organizations in global politics are essential for managing the complexities of an interconnected world. They provide mechanisms for cooperation, conflict resolution, and collective action. However, they also face challenges such as unequal power dynamics, limited enforcement capabilities, and differing national interests. Despite these challenges, their role remains vital in addressing global issues and promoting a more stable and cooperative international system.

THE UNITED NATIONS

International Organization, Structure & Role

The Contemporary World



What is the United Nations?

 **Founded**

October 24, 1945

 **Founding Members**

51 Countries

 **Current Members**

193 Members

PH Philippines

Founding Member

About the UN

The United Nations is considered the world's leading international organization and an indispensable part of the global political arena.

According to Thakur (2011), it is both a global governance actor and site — composed of universal state membership and mechanisms for involving non-state actors.

The UN serves as a central clearing house for information and actions among nations.

Core Principles of the UN Charter

01

International Peace & Security

To maintain stability and prevent conflict between nations around the world.

02

Friendly Relations Among Nations

To develop peaceful and cooperative ties between all member states.

03

Cooperation & Human Rights

To cooperate in solving international problems and in promoting respect for human rights.

04

Center for Harmonizing Actions

To be a center for aligning and harmonizing the actions of all nations.

Before the UN: The League of Nations

The League (1919)

- Established at the Paris Peace Conference of 1919
- Goal: collective security, arbitrate disputes, disarmament
- Set up in the aftermath of World War I

Why It Failed

- USA never joined (isolationist Congress)
- Germany joined 1926, left 1933 (Nazis)
- Japan left 1933; Italy left 1936
- Soviet Union expelled 1939
- No binding resolutions; recommendations only
- No mechanism to coordinate military action

Result: League failed to prevent WWII → Led to creation of the UN

The Six Principal Organs of the UN



Security Council



General Assembly



Secretariat



ECOSOC



Trusteeship Council



Int'l Court of Justice

Security Council & General Assembly

☐ Security Council

- 15 members total
- 5 Permanent: USA, Britain, France, Russia, China
- 10 Non-permanent members
- Decisions: binding resolutions
- Requires 9 out of 15 votes to pass
- **Permanent members hold VETO power**

☐ General Assembly

- Parliament of all UN nations
- All 193 members represented
- Each country has ONE vote
- Considers world's pressing problems
- Key issues: 2/3 majority vote needed
- **Decisions are recommendations only**

Other Key Organs of the UN

The Secretariat

- Carries administrative & substantive work
- Headed by the Secretary-General
- ~40,000 staff worldwide
- Lacks political power and right of initiative

ECOSOC

- Coordinates economic & social work of UN
- Under authority of the General Assembly
- Links UN with civil society / NGOs
- Coordinates UN family organizations

Trusteeship Council

- Supervised 11 Trust Territories
- Ensured steps toward self-government
- All territories gained independence by 1994
- Now consists of 5 permanent SC members

Int'l Court of Justice

- Main judicial organ of the UN
- 15 judges elected by GA & Security Council
- Decides disputes between countries
- Provides advisory opinions to UN organs

UN Specialized Agencies & Programs

The UN also includes a range of specialized agencies, funds, and programs:



IMF

International Monetary Fund



WB

The World Bank



WHO

World Health Organization



UNESCO

UN Educational, Scientific & Cultural
Organization



UNICEF

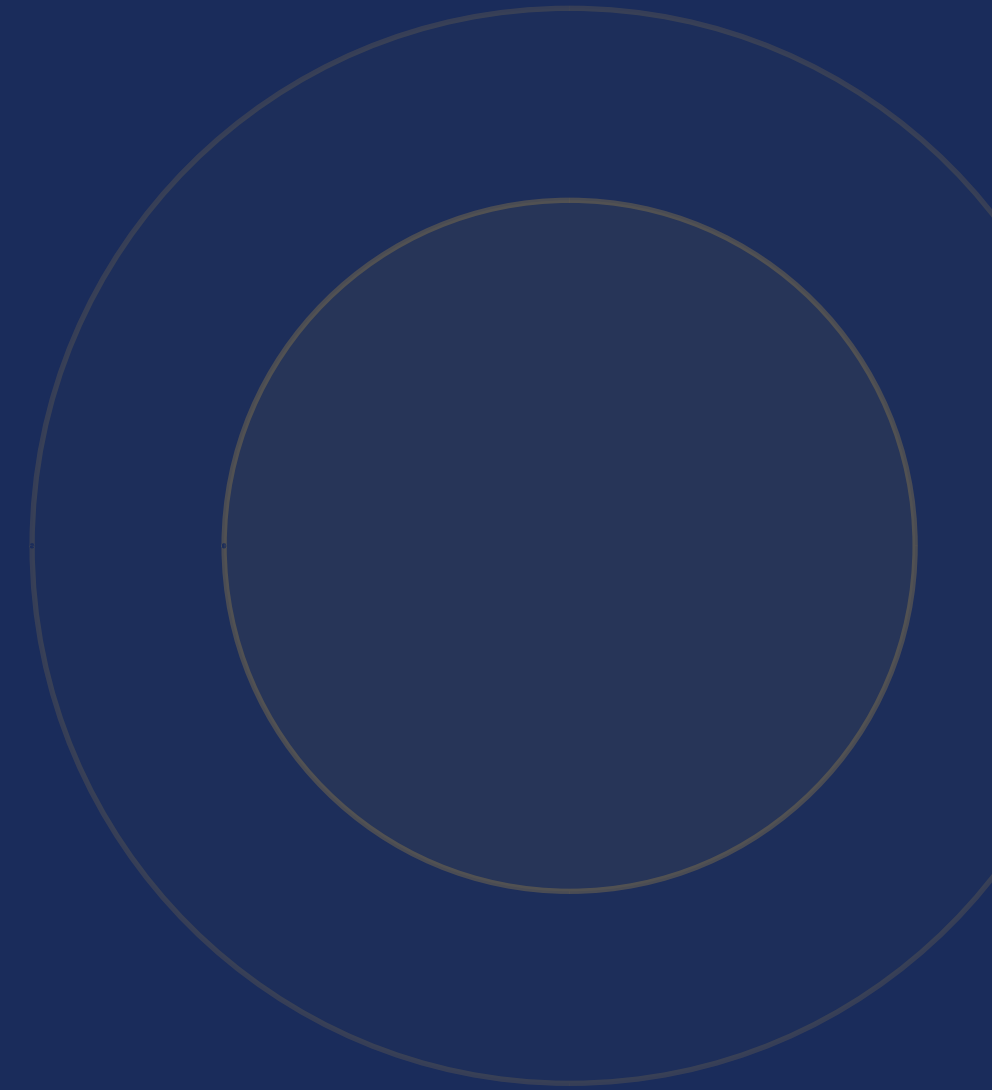
UN Children's Fund

GLOBALIZATION

and the UN System

The Contemporary World

Weiss & Thakur (2010) | Steger (2003) | Heine & Thakur (2011)



What is Globalization?

Definition (Steger, 2003): The expansion and intensification of social relations and consciousness across world-time and world-space.

Economic Dimensions

- Expansion across state borders
- Finance & investment flows
- Trade in goods and services

Social & Cultural Dimensions

- Exchange of ideas & information
- Growth of international organizations
- Cultural exchanges & interactions

Opposing Views on Globalization

✓ POSITIVE VIEW

- Equally desirable and important engine of growth
- Paved the way for progress
- Higher standard of living for many
- Promotes interconnectedness across borders

✗ CRITICAL VIEW

- A new form of Western dominance
- Only big/powerful countries benefit
- Widening inequality among nations
- Marginalizes developing countries

Weiss & Thakur (2010): Key Clarifications

1

People's Movements Restricted

Even in a globalizing era, movement of people remains strictly regulated — especially after 9/11.

2

Asymmetrical Interdependence

Developing countries are highly dependent on industrialized ones; economic interdependence is unequal.

3

Growing Inequality

Income divergence — not convergence — is widening both between and within nations.

4

Uncivil Society Forces

Globalization has unleashed terrorism, drug trafficking, gun running, and illicit money flows. (Heine & Thakur, 2011)

The Role of the UN System

According to Weiss & Thakur (2010)



Globalization creates both winners and losers. Problems are not caused by globalization itself but by deficiencies in its governance.

Greater Legitimacy

UN provides internationally recognized authority

Lower Costs

Reduced transaction & compliance costs for member states

Higher Comfort

Greater acceptance and stability for most countries

Role of United Nations In Global Politics

Four Essential Roles in Identifying and Resolving Global Concerns

Based on the framework by Weiss and Thakur (2011)

Comparative Advantage

The UN's Unique Position

- Possesses a distinct comparative advantage in identifying and resolving global concerns.

A World Organization

- Acts as a central hub for state governments, NGOs, and civil societies.

The Four Essential Roles:

- Managing Knowledge
- Developing Norms
- Formulating Recommendations
- Institutionalizing Ideas

Managing Knowledge

Identifying the Problem

- Tackles issues from atomic energy and climate change to sea regulations and internet traffic.

Gathering Solid Information

- Relies on basic research generated by universities and knowledge-based organizations.

Mobilizing Power

- Uses its convening capacity to bring outside knowledge to state governments for discussion and dissemination.

Developing Norms

Why Norms Matter

- International institutions are run by human beings; standards of behavior are essential for society to function.

From Data to Standards

- Once a problem is recognized by the policy community, new norms are developed.

The Process

- Articulate
- Disseminate
- Institutionalize

Formulating Recommendations

Altering Behavior

- Creating strategies for governments and Intergovernmental Organizations (IGOs) to adapt to new norms.

The Rise of Civil Society

- NGOs and civil societies are louder and bolder in the 21st century.

UN Charter Article 71

- Officially recognizes and provides for the participation of NGOs.

The Challenge

- Recommendations only work if member states take responsibility for the next steps.

Institutionalizing Ideas

Overseeing Implementation

- Existing institutions monitor the newly formulated policies.

Creating New IGOs

- For problems of massive gravity and scale, entirely new organizations are built.

Real-World Example

UNAIDS (1996)

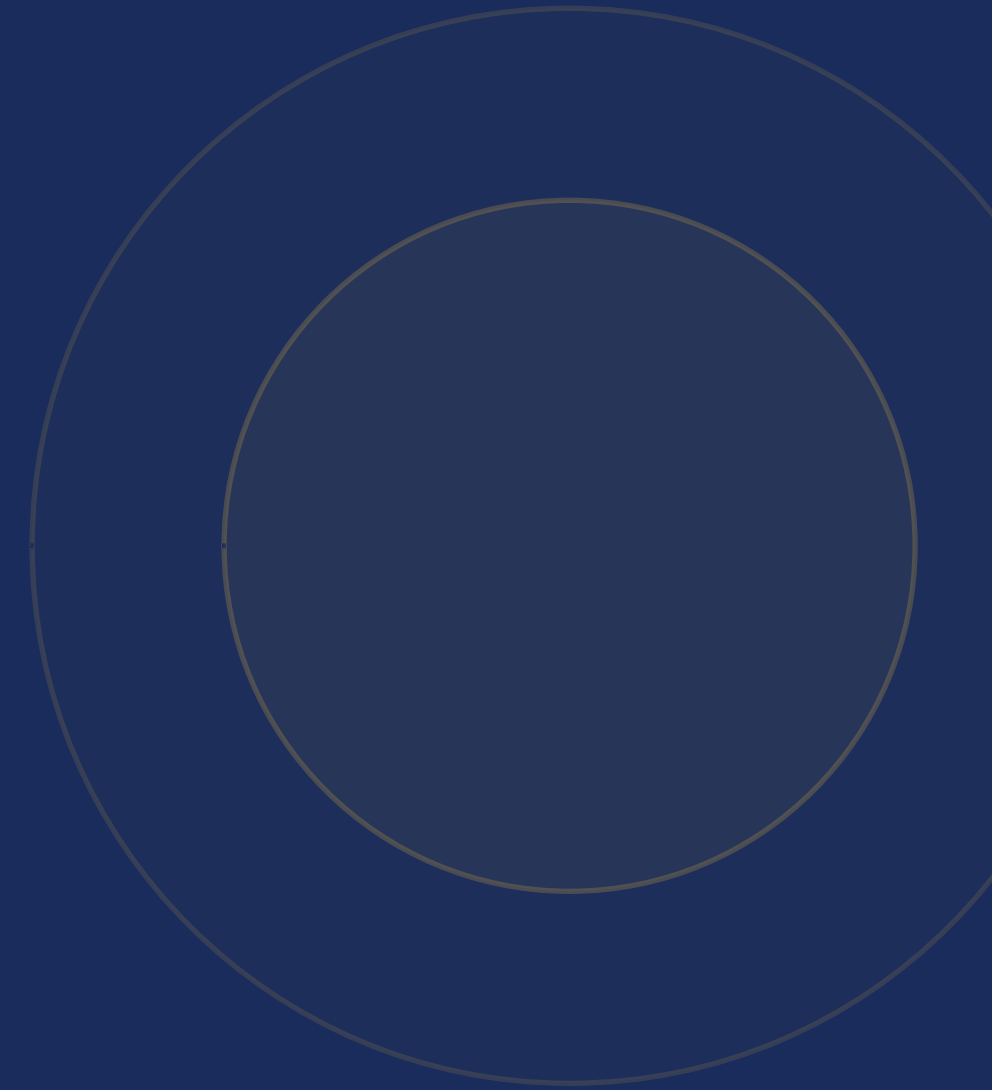
- Created by the WHO's World Health Assembly as the principal instrument for global action on the HIV/AIDS epidemic.

Summary of the UN's Strategy

- **Know: Manage the knowledge.**
- **Standardize: Develop the norms.**
- **Propose: Formulate recommendations.**
- **Execute: Institutionalize the ideas.**

UN Challenges and

Responses to Issues



Expectations vs. Reality

Over 70 Years of Operation

- The UN has been continuously challenged by different controversies and criticisms.

The 'Ideational Role'

- Expectations do not always meet the UN's actual performance as the principal global governance actor.

Broad Areas of UN Activity

A Wide Range of Responsibilities

- Expected to be active in various global sectors.

Key Areas

- Refugee protection
- Environment
- Counter-terrorism
- Human rights
- Disarmament
- Socio-economic Development.

The Main Role: Peace and Security

The Core Function

- The widely accepted main role is the maintenance of peace and security.

The Security Council

- The main organ responsible for carrying out this mandate.

Success Stories

- Peacekeeping in Mozambique and El Salvador, and peace-building in East Timor.

Major Failures and Reputational Damage

The Mid-1990s Crises

- The UN failed to prevent large-scale slaughter.

Specific Failures

- The crises in Rwanda and Bosnia (Heywood, 2011).

Damaged Reputation

- These events severely damaged how the world views the UN.

Conclusion

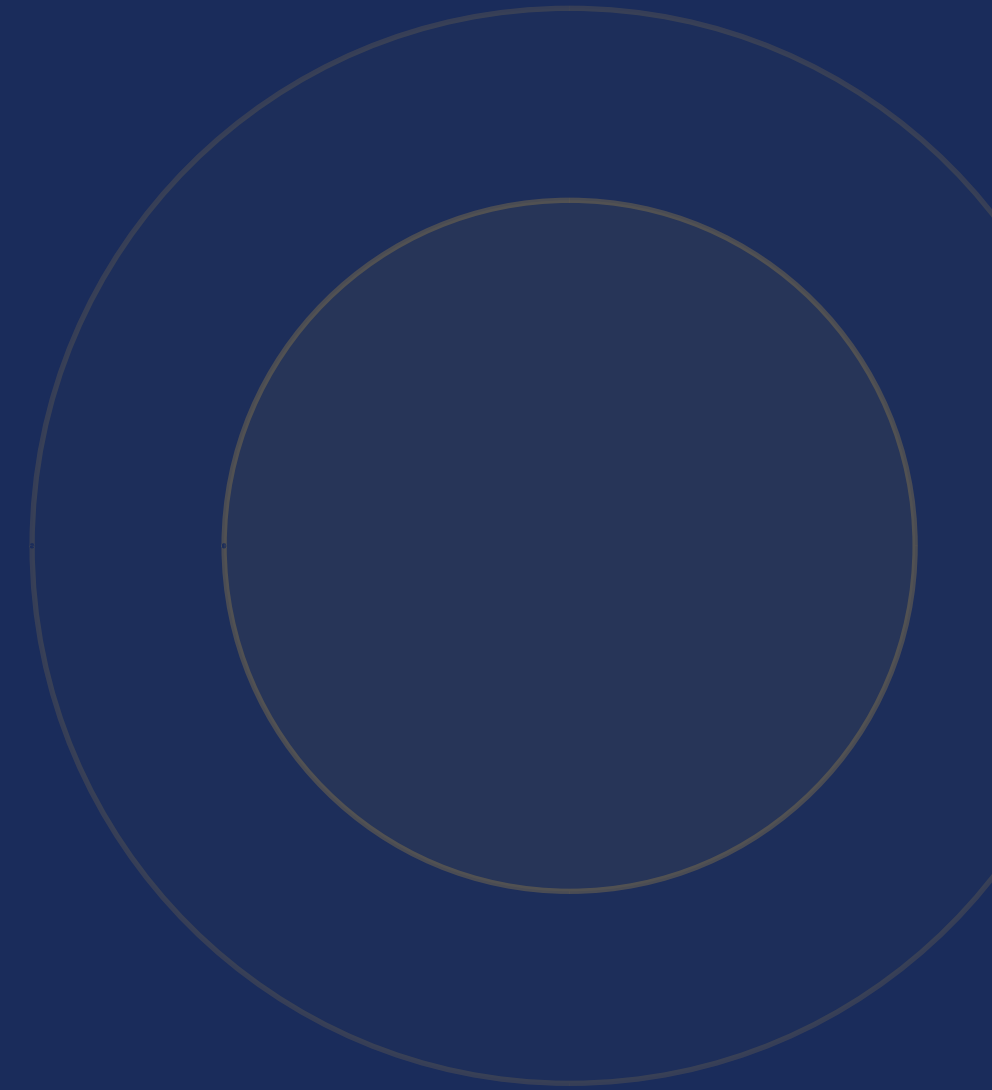
A Continuous Challenge

- **The UN is pressured to take on a stronger role in maintaining global order.**

Maritime Dispute in

the West Philippine Sea

The Contemporary World



Introduction

The maritime dispute in the West Philippine Sea, part of the larger South China Sea conflict, remains one of the most significant geopolitical challenges today. It involves competing territorial claims, access to natural resources, and strategic control of vital sea lanes. Despite the role of international organizations such as the United Nations (UN), resolving the dispute continues to be difficult due to conflicting national interests and limited enforcement mechanisms.

Background of the Dispute

The conflict involves several island groups and maritime features, including the Paracel Islands, Spratly Islands, and Macclesfield Bank. These areas are believed to contain valuable natural resources and are crucial for international trade routes. China and Taiwan claim nearly the entire South China Sea, while the Philippines, Vietnam, Malaysia, and Brunei assert claims over portions nearest to their coastlines. The Philippines bases its claim on its Exclusive Economic Zone (EEZ), as defined by international law.

Scarborough Shoal Incident (2012)

Tensions escalated in 2012 during the Scarborough Shoal standoff, when Chinese vessels prevented Filipino fishermen from accessing the area. This incident demonstrated China's increasing assertiveness and raised concerns about the Philippines' sovereignty and maritime rights.

Legal Action and UNCLOS Arbitration (2013–2016)

In 2013, the Philippines filed an arbitration case under the United Nations Convention on the Law of the Sea (UNCLOS) before the International Tribunal for the Law of the Sea (ITLOS). The case challenged China's expansive "nine-dash line" claim. China, however, refused to participate in the proceedings. It insisted that it was the victim in the maritime dispute and declared that it would never accept any decision made by the UN arbitral tribunal. Furthermore, China stated that it would not accept any imposed solution or third-party settlement.

2016 Arbitral Tribunal Ruling

In 2016, the tribunal ruled in favor of the Philippines. The key findings include:

- China's "nine-dash line" has no legal basis under international law.
- None of the disputed features claimed by China qualify as islands capable of generating an EEZ.
- Certain maritime areas fall within the Philippines' EEZ.

- China violated the Philippines' sovereign rights by:
 - Interfering with fishing and petroleum exploration
 - Constructing artificial islands
 - Allowing Chinese fishermen to operate within the zone
- Despite this ruling, China refused to recognize or comply with the decision.

China's Response and International Reactions

China's non-recognition of the arbitration ruling led to mixed reactions from the international community. Many countries and international organizations supported peaceful conflict resolution based on international law, particularly UNCLOS. However, China continued to ignore the ruling.

Reports indicated that China had nearly completed the transformation of several reefs in the disputed area into military bases. This development raised further concerns about regional security and stability.

Limitations of the United Nations

The situation highlights the limitations of the United Nations in enforcing international rulings. After the tribunal's decision, the UN did not strongly impose or enforce the verdict against China.

According to Klare (2017), the legal mechanisms for resolving maritime boundary disputes remain underdeveloped. Additionally, many countries are reluctant to give up authority over territorial matters, making enforcement and resolution even more difficult.

Conclusion

"Problems Without Passports"

- The Global Reality: According to former UN Secretary Kofi Annan, modern crises (Climate Change, Pandemics, Terrorism) are "problems without passports."
- The Strategy: These issues require "solutions without passports"—global policy-making that crosses borders.

The Only Custodian of Sovereignty

- Universal Legitimacy: The UN is regarded as the only organization with the unique authority to manage world affairs.
- Sovereignty vs. Human Rights: The UN respects Non-Intervention (State privacy). However: Intervention is justifiable when there are extreme transgressions of human rights or threats to international peace and security.

The Final Verdict: An Indispensable Actor

- More Than a Meeting Place: The UN is not just a site for leaders to meet; it is the most important actor in Global Governance.
- Humankind's Most Ambitious Effort: It is the primary tool for managing the challenges of the 21st century.
- The Goal: The UN needs to be improved and complemented, rather than abandoned or supplanted (Weiss and Thakur, 2011).